QP CODE - 25901210

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS)

REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG4DSCDMP200 - NEW MEDIA AND CITIZEN JOURNALISM

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks : 70**

PART A — Multiple Choice Questions

1 a) Figma

2 c) New Media

3 b) User experience design

4 a) Virtual Reality

5 b) Entertainment

6 b) Fact checking

7 c) Internet

8 b) Reporting local, social, cultural, and emergency events

9 d) By providing real-time coverage

PART B — Short Answer Questions *(3 Marks)*

11. Summarize the role of content professionals in new media

- Content professionals in new media create, curate, edit, and distribute digital content across platforms including websites, social media, podcasts, and video channels
- They are responsible for audience research, SEO optimisation, analytics interpretation, and ensuring content aligns with platform algorithms and organisational objectives
- Their roles span writing, multimedia production, community management, and data-driven content strategy in converged digital environments

12. Explain the social impact of new media on culture and society

- New media has democratised information access, enabling marginalised communities to participate in public discourse and challenge dominant cultural narratives
- It has transformed social relationships, enabling global connectivity while also contributing to echo chambers, digital addiction, and erosion of privacy
- New media shapes cultural trends, political opinions, and social movements through viral content, influencer culture, and platform-driven public debate

13. How does framing influence the way people understand news?

- Framing refers to the way news stories are presented — the angle, language, and emphasis chosen — which shapes how audiences interpret and assign meaning to events
- The same event framed differently can evoke contrasting emotional responses and political conclusions in audiences
- Framing influences public opinion by highlighting certain aspects of an issue while downplaying others, reflecting the editorial or ideological priorities of the media outlet

14. Explain how new media transforms communication patterns

- New media has shifted communication from linear, one-to-many broadcast models to interactive, many-to-many networked exchanges, enabling real-time dialogue between producers and audiences
- It has introduced asynchronous and synchronous communication formats — email, messaging apps, live streaming — collapsing geographic and time barriers
- User-generated content, citizen journalism, and social media have disrupted traditional gatekeeping, giving individuals unprecedented power to create and distribute information globally

15. Why should citizen journalists be accountable to the public?

- Citizen journalists influence public opinion and inform community decision-making, making accuracy and responsibility as critical as in professional journalism
- Without accountability, citizen journalism risks spreading misinformation, invading privacy, and causing reputational harm to individuals and communities
- Accountability builds audience trust, legitimises citizen journalism as a credible information source, and upholds the democratic function of journalism in society

16. Explain the principle of public interest in journalism

- The public interest principle holds that journalism must serve the informational needs of citizens rather than the private interests of individuals, corporations, or governments
- It justifies investigative reporting, whistleblowing coverage, and disclosure of information that authorities may prefer to suppress
- Public interest is the ethical foundation that distinguishes responsible journalism from sensationalism, invasion of privacy, or commercially motivated content

17. How does citizen journalism help the common people?

- Citizen journalism gives ordinary people a platform to report hyperlocal issues — civic problems, community events, local injustices — that mainstream media often overlooks
- It empowers marginalised communities to tell their own stories without dependence on professional media gatekeepers
- During crises and emergencies, citizen journalists provide immediate, ground-level coverage that reaches the public faster than traditional news organisations

18. Explain the role of ethics in citizen journalism

- Ethics in citizen journalism encompasses accuracy, fairness, privacy respect, informed consent, and avoiding harm — principles that ensure responsible reporting
- Without professional editorial oversight, citizen journalists must self-regulate, making personal ethical commitment essential to credible practice
- Ethical citizen journalism strengthens public trust, prevents misinformation, and protects the dignity of individuals featured in reports

19. Describe remote interview

- A remote interview is a journalistic conversation conducted between interviewer and subject across different locations using digital communication tools such as Zoom, Google Meet, Skype, or phone calls
- It enables journalists to access sources regardless of geographic distance, making it essential for citizen journalists with limited travel resources
- Key considerations include stable internet connectivity, audio/video quality, obtaining consent for recording, and ensuring clarity of communication despite technical limitations

20. List the features of a mobile audio editing application

- Multi-track editing capability allowing simultaneous recording and mixing of multiple audio layers
- Tools for cutting, trimming, fading, noise reduction, and equalisation to refine audio quality
- Export options in multiple formats (MP3, WAV, AAC) and direct sharing to podcasting or social media platforms
- Examples include Audacity (desktop), GarageBand, and Adobe Podcast

21. Analyse how the 5W 1H framework strengthens the completeness and credibility of a news story

- The 5W1H framework — Who, What, When, Where, Why, and How — ensures a news story addresses all fundamental informational dimensions, leaving no critical gaps for the audience
- Answering each element systematically prevents incomplete reporting, which is a common weakness in citizen journalism produced under time pressure
- A story built on 5W1H demonstrates journalistic rigour, enhances factual accuracy, and builds audience confidence in the credibility of the report

22. Name two free video editing tools used by citizen journalists and state one key feature of each.

- DaVinci Resolve — offers professional-grade colour correction and multi-track timeline editing at no cost, suitable for detailed post-production
- CapCut — a mobile-first editing tool featuring auto-captions, templates, transitions, and direct social media export, ideal for quick turnaround citizen journalism content

PART C — Essay Questions *(15 Marks)*

23. Discuss editing, proofreading, and quality control in blogging

- Editing involves reviewing blog content for structural coherence, logical flow, relevance, clarity of argument, and appropriate tone for the target audience
- Proofreading is the final check for grammatical errors, spelling mistakes, punctuation issues, and typographical errors before publication
- Quality control encompasses fact verification, plagiarism checking, link validation, image attribution, and SEO review to ensure the post meets editorial and technical standards
- Tools such as Grammarly, Hemingway Editor, and Copyscape assist bloggers in maintaining writing quality and originality
- Consistent editing and quality control build reader trust, improve search engine ranking, and establish the blogger's credibility and professional reputation over time

24. Discuss the importance of credibility and respect for others in citizen journalism

- Credibility is the cornerstone of citizen journalism — without verified, accurate, and fairly presented information, citizen reports risk causing harm and losing public trust
- Building credibility requires transparent sourcing, corroboration of facts from multiple sources, clear distinction between fact and opinion, and willingness to issue corrections
- Respect for others demands that citizen journalists protect the dignity, privacy, and safety of individuals featured in their reports, particularly vulnerable subjects
- Avoiding sensationalism, stereotyping, and intrusive reporting upholds the ethical standard that journalism — professional or citizen — must not cause unnecessary harm
- When citizen journalism demonstrates consistent credibility and respectful practice, it earns legitimacy alongside professional media and strengthens the democratic information ecosystem

25. Explain objectivity, clarity, and fact-based communication in citizen journalism

- Objectivity requires citizen journalists to present multiple perspectives fairly, minimise personal bias, and distinguish between factual reporting and personal opinion
- While complete objectivity is debated in media theory, striving for impartiality ensures that citizen journalism informs rather than manipulates audiences
- Clarity demands that reports are written or presented in accessible, unambiguous language — avoiding jargon, complex sentence structures, and assumptions about audience knowledge
- Fact-based communication requires verification of all claims through credible sources, official records, eyewitness accounts, or documented evidence before publication
- Together, these principles elevate citizen journalism from personal commentary to a legitimate, trustworthy form of public information that complements professional media practice

26. Elaborate on the essential tools and techniques a citizen journalist requires to practise journalism effectively?

- Hardware tools — a smartphone with a quality camera, external microphone, portable tripod, power bank, and mobile data connectivity form the basic citizen journalist's kit
- Recording and production tools — video recording apps, mobile audio recorders, and editing apps such as CapCut, GarageBand, and Adobe Rush enable field production and post-production without professional equipment
- Publishing platforms — blogs (WordPress), social media (YouTube, Instagram, Twitter/X), and community news platforms serve as distribution channels for citizen journalism content
- Verification tools — Google Reverse Image Search, InVID, Snopes, and fact-checking databases help citizen journalists verify information and images before publishing
- Ethical and legal awareness — understanding defamation law, privacy rights, informed consent, and copyright is as essential as any technical tool in ensuring responsible, sustainable citizen journalism practice